UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.3 · CULTURE LAB

TEACHER CREDIT

GLUE OR WEDGE?

LAB WORKSHEET **ANSWER KEY**

Does culture hold a country together, or pull it apart?

Name _____ Partner _____ Period _____

START HERE · TWO FORCES

GLUE

CENTRIPETAL

Remember: flower petals. Flowers bring people together.

A centripetal force **pulls people toward the center**. It unites a country. Examples: a shared language, a shared religion, a national team.

WEDGE

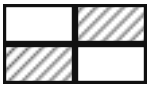
CENTRIFUGAL

Remember: the FU says it all. It pushes people away.

A centrifugal force **pushes people away from the center**. It divides a country and can lead to separatism, which means a group wants its own country.



STACK (reinforcing): language, religion, and identity all split in the **same place**. Usually a wedge.



CROSS (cross-cutting): the lines **cross**, so people who differ in one way share something else. Usually glue.

Directions: 1. Open the lab with your partner. 2. For each case, answer A to D in order: Read, Map, Street, Verdict. 3. Answer the Compare question after each matchup. Pace: about 4 minutes per country. Circle letters: L = Language, R = Religion, I = Identity, G = Glue, W = Wedge, N = Neither.

CASE 1 · BELGIUM FLANDERS AND BRUSSELS, EUROPE

1A **Read.** In 1962, the government drew an official language border across the country. READ

Divides people: Dutch vs. French language; wealth gap **Shared glue:** Catholic heritage, Red Devils, monarchy

1B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: (LANGUAGE) RELIGION (IDENTITY) NONE

The differences mostly (circle ONE): (STACK) CROSS Map answer: A (B) C D

1C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	Church on the square	L (R) I	(G) W N	Catholic heritage on both sides
2	Black lion flag	L R (I)	G (W) N	Flemish nationalism: Flanders first
3	Road sign with French painted out	(L) R I	G (W) N	claims the space for Dutch only
4	Red Devils banner	L R (I)	(G) W N	fans cheer in both languages

1D **Verdict.** GLUE 1 2 (3) (4) 5 WEDGE In Belgium, culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because: VERDICT

Accept 3 or 4 with evidence. Language, identity, and wealth stack on one line (541 days with no government), but shared Catholicism and the Red Devils hold it together.

CASE 2 · SWITZERLAND — BIEL/BIENNE, EUROPE

2A **Read.** Every Swiss student must study a **second** national language. READ

Divides people: four languages; mild voting gaps **Shared glue:** religion crosses language; cantons

2B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: LANGUAGE RELIGION IDENTITY **(NONE)**

The differences mostly (circle ONE): STACK **(CROSS)** Map answer: A B C **(D)**

2C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	Station sign	**(L)** R I	**(G)** W N	city is officially bilingual
2	Reformed church	L **(R)** I	**(G)** W N	congregation bridges language groups
3	School language poster	**(L)** R I	**(G)** W N	students learn a 2nd national language
4	Referendum poster	**(L)** R **(I)**	G **(W)** N	Röstigraben: groups vote differently (mild)

2D **Verdict.** GLUE **(1)** **(2)** 3 4 5 WEDGE In Switzerland, culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because: VERDICT

Accept 1 or 2 with evidence. Religion lines cross language lines, so no group's whole identity lines up against another.

Cantons share power and students learn each other's languages.

MATCHUP 1 · COMPARE BELGIUM AND SWITZERLAND

M1 Both countries mix Germanic and Romance languages. Why does language work more like glue in Switzerland and more like a wedge in Belgium? COMPARE

Sample: Switzerland's religion lines cross its language lines and cantons share power, so no group lines up against another. In Belgium, language, identity, and wealth all split on the same north-south line, so the differences stack.

CASE 3 · QUEBEC (CANADA) — MONTREAL, NORTH AMERICA

3A **Read.** Bill 101 (1977) made **French** the main language of work, school, and signs. READ

Divides people: French vs. English; Québécois identity **Shared glue:** federal bilingualism; voted to stay twice

3B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: **(LANGUAGE)** **(RELIGION)** **(IDENTITY)** NONE (faded)

The differences mostly (circle ONE): **(STACK)** CROSS Map answer: **(A)** B C D

3C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	Stop sign	**(L)** R I	G **(W)** N	French by law sets Quebec apart
2	Post office sign	**(L)** R I	**(G)** W N	federal bilingualism is a bridge
3	License plate	L R **(I)**	G **(W)** N	Québécois identity first
4	Church for sale	L **(R)** I	G W **(N)**	religion faded since the 1960s

3D **Verdict.** GLUE 1 2 **(3)** **(4)** 5 WEDGE In Quebec (Canada), culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because: VERDICT

Accept 3 or 4 with evidence. Language carries Québécois identity and fueled two independence votes (1995 lost by about 1%), but federal bilingualism and two No votes keep Canada together.

CASE 4 · NORTHERN IRELAND — BELFAST, EUROPE

4A **Read.** Everyone speaks English, but people are divided by _____ and _____. READ

Divides people: Catholic vs. Protestant; Irish vs. British **Shared glue:** shared English; Good Friday Agreement

4B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: LANGUAGE (RELIGION) (IDENTITY) NONE

The differences mostly (circle ONE): (STACK) CROSS Map answer: A B (C) D

4C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	Peace wall	L (R) (I)	G (W) N	separates Catholic and Protestant areas
2	Painted curbs and flag	L (R) (I)	G (W) N	marks a unionist area (territory)
3	Irish-language street sign	(L) R I	G (W) N	Irish marks nationalist identity
4	Integrated school sign	L (R) I	(G) W N	mixes Catholic and Protestant kids

4D **Verdict.** GLUE 1 2 3 (4) (5) WEDGE VERDICT

In Northern Ireland, culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because:

Accept 4 or 5 with evidence. Religion and national identity stack, so peace walls, murals, and separate schools still divide people even though everyone shares English.

MATCHUP 2 · COMPARE QUEBEC AND NORTHERN IRELAND

M2 Northern Ireland shares one language but is still divided. What does that tell you about language compared with religion and identity? COMPARE

Sample: Language is only one layer. Northern Ireland shows that religion and national identity can divide people who share a language. In Quebec, language now carries the identity that religion once did.

CASE 5 · SRI LANKA — COLOMBO AND JAFFNA, ASIA

5A **Read.** The 1956 Sinhala Only Act made one group's language the only official language. READ

Divides people: language, religion, ethnicity all line up **Shared glue:** Tamil official since 1987; cricket

5B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: (LANGUAGE) (RELIGION) (IDENTITY) NONE

The differences mostly (circle ONE): (STACK) CROSS Map answer: A B C (D)

5C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	Three-language sign	(L) R I	(G) W N	Tamil official since 1987
2	Buddhist stupa	L (R) I	G (W) N	Buddhism given the foremost place
3	War-damaged building	L R (I)	G (W) N	civil war scars, 1983 to 2009
4	Cricket poster	L R (I)	(G) W N	fans across ethnic lines

5D **Verdict.** GLUE 1 2 3 (4) (5) WEDGE VERDICT

In Sri Lanka, culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because:

Accept 4 or 5 with evidence. Language, religion, and ethnicity all stack, and the 1956 law tied power to one side, which helped lead to a civil war from 1983 to 2009.

CASE 6 · INDONESIA JAKARTA, ASIA

6A **Read.** Leaders chose **Malay**, a trade language, as the national language instead of Javanese. READ

Divides people: 700+ languages; Papua and Aceh **Shared glue:** national language; Islam (87%); motto

6B **Map.** Review each layer, then check Fault lines. MAP

Circle the layers that split on the **same** line: LANGUAGE (RELIGION) (IDENTITY) NONE (Bali, Papua)

The differences mostly (circle ONE): STACK (CROSS) Map answer: A B (C) D

6C **Street.** For each clue, circle the layer and the force. STREET

	CLUE	LAYER	FORCE	WHY? (A FEW WORDS)
1	School banner	(L) R I	(G) W N	neutral shared national language
2	Mosque and cathedral	L (R) I	(G) W N	mosque and cathedral linked: harmony
3	National motto banner	L R (I)	(G) W N	Unity in Diversity
4	Morning Star flag graffiti	L R (I)	G (W) N	Papuan independence symbol

6D **Verdict.** GLUE (1) (2) 3 4 5 WEDGE In Indonesia, culture acts mostly as glue / wedge because: VERDICT

Accept 1 or 2 with evidence. A neutral national language crosses hundreds of ethnic groups, most people share Islam, and the motto celebrates diversity. Papua is the main exception.

MATCHUP 3 · COMPARE SRI LANKA AND INDONESIA

M3 Both governments chose a national language. Why did Sri Lanka's choice divide the country while Indonesia's helped unite it? COMPARE

Sample: Sri Lanka chose the majority group's language, which shut Tamil speakers out of jobs and stacked on religion and ethnicity. Indonesia chose a neutral trade language that no group owned, so no one group won.

WRAP-UP · THE BIG PICTURE

W1 Write each country's name on the line, from most glue to most wedge. Sample order; accept others backed by evidence.

MOST GLUE — Switzerland | Indonesia | Belgium | Quebec | N. Ireland | Sri Lanka — MOST WEDGE

W2 **Exit FRQ, Part A.** Describe how religion can act as a centrifugal force, even in a place where people share a language. Use a real example from the lab. FRQ

Sample: In Northern Ireland, everyone speaks English, but Catholics (mostly Irish nationalists) and Protestants (mostly British unionists) live in separate neighborhoods, attend separate schools, and are divided by peace walls. Religion stacks with national identity, so it pulls people apart even without a language divide.

W3 **Exit FRQ, Part B.** Explain why a national language policy can unify one country but divide another. Use evidence from TWO different countries. FRQ

Sample: Sri Lanka's 1956 Sinhala Only Act chose the majority's language, so Tamil speakers lost access to jobs and universities, which fed a civil war. Indonesia chose Malay, a neutral trade language no group owned, so every group shared it equally and it became glue.